

Class Armstrong - End of Year Revision Exam

1. Studied Poetry (10 marks)

Give an example of a memorable metaphor or simile used by a poet that you encountered in your study of English for Junior Cycle. Explain why this metaphor or simile was memorable for you.

In "The Road Not Taken" by Robert Frost, he uses a metaphor to explain life choices and their consequences. He stands at a split in a path and he must make a decision. He felt upset, he "could not travel both", but knew he had to make a decision. He took the road less traveled by, a metaphor for his life as a poet, and knew his decision was final once it had been made.

This metaphor was memorable for me because it creates a striking image of a man choosing between "two roads" that "diverged in a yellow wood". It brings to mind all of the choices one makes in life and how they all change the direction of things, forever. Robert Frost's use of imagery also helped make the metaphor memorable, as the idea was associated with a scene in my head.

2. Studied Novel (20 marks)

"A good story is always a journey. It is about taking the journey, the people the hero meets along the way and how they change him or her". Michael Scott

Using a novel or a film you have studied, describe a journey taken by a character in this text. This journey may be a physical journey or a journey of self-discovery.

(a) Explain, using reference to the text, what this journey involved for your chosen character. Refer to other characters they encounter on the journey.

Title of novel or film: The Outsiders

Name of author or director: S. E. Hinton

Name of character: Dally

Dallas Winston embarks on a journey of self-discovery in the novel. In the beginning, when ~~the~~ Johnny Ponyboy and himself encounter Cherry and Marlon at the movie showing, his outer shell is strong and unyielding. He attempts to assert dominance over the girls. He helps the boys out, but is very reserved in his ~~own~~ display of emotion.

His journey truly begins when the boys come to him having killed a Soc. He truly feels, for the first time, that he is responsible for others. He directs them to an "abandoned" church in Wheelbarrow and shows that he can function as a human being when he cares. It deeply affects him, then, when Johnny dies from the injuries he sustained in the fire. He feels responsible for the death and believes

(b) As a result of this journey, how was your chosen character changed? Did your opinion of this character change as a result of this? Explain using reference to the text.

Dallas was deeply changed by Johnny's death. His strong outer shell of indifference and uncaring finally cracked, revealing the anger and sadness that lay within his heart. He purposely gets shot by police in a shoot out, not letting the other Greasers know until it's too late to stop him. They worry when they realize "Dally's gone", showing that Dallas's belief he is alone in the world is untrue and that others cared for him. He died unheralded by the world, pitifully.

My opinion of the character did change as a result of this. I felt much more

empathy for him when he showed true feelings after Johnny's passing. When ~~he died~~ Dallas himself died and Sonya remarked on the sad situation that Dallas would never have a shock of the goodness he held so deeply within him, known to the world at large, it made me feel sympathetic and helped me see the world from Dallas's perspective.

3. Shakespearean Drama (15 marks)

From a Shakespearean play you have studied, choose one character who struggles with elements of the world they live in and/or the other characters who live in this world.

Give an account of how your chosen character struggles in their world and what causes these struggles. Explain using suitable quotation from the text.

Title of play: The Merchant of Venice

Name of character: Antonio

Antonio faces many struggles throughout the play, and even at the end of it, he does not feel fulfilled. From the

beginning to the end of the play, he feels an approaching sadness upon him. He claims that he ~~all~~ "know[s]" not why he is so sad and that it "weighs" him. Though Solanio and Solanio attempt to find the reason, he does not come to a conclusion as to why, which only serves to further nag at him.

Antonio must also bother himself in the coming for of Bassanio. Though he claims it does not cause him any detriment, saying that all he has and can do "lie all unlocked to [Bassanio's] occasions", the consequences of Bassanio's actions and inactions result in the majority of the conflict faced by Antonio through the show.

Though Bassanio's actions may cause this conflict, it is cracked at the hands of Shylock, the Jewish moneylender. He claims that "I hate him for he is a Christian" and stops at nothing short of sacrificing all he has to murder Antonio. In fact, Shylock almost kills Antonio before he is stopped by Portia, which only negatively affects Antonio's state of mind, which is already fragile.

4. Non-Shakespearean Drama (15 marks)

From a prescribed Shakespearean play you have studied, choose two characters who are experiencing conflict with each other.

Eliza and Hamilton

(a) Discuss the causes of the conflict between the two characters, using reference to a specific moment(s) from the play.

In "Hamilton" by Lin-Manuel Miranda, Eliza and Alexander Hamilton face conflict in the form of how they wish to live their lives. During the American War of Independence, Eliza succeeds in having Alexander's commander send him home stating "we don't need a legacy". This angers Hamilton, who wishes to earn fame and power by fighting in the war, and symbolises the first major conflict of their previously fairy tale-esque love for one another.

When Hamilton faces stressors while working in the new American government, he is seduced by Maria Reynolds. To protect his legacy, he releases "The Reynolds Pamphlet", detailing his relations with Maria. This infuriates Eliza, and she says he "told

Extra Writing Space

2a. that the ~~only~~ only positive impact he ever had turned out killing someone.

4a. the whole world" about what should have been an extremely private matter. Eliza becomes more withdrawn from Hamilton in

response.

When Hamilton, over-protective of his legacy, enters into a duel with Aaron Burr, he comes directly into conflict with what Eliza wants of him. In his final thoughts, he says to Eliza "I'll see you on the other side". Eliza, devastated by the death of her husband, forgives him in full for all of his trespasses against her, and devotes the rest of her life to his legacy.

Name: Oisín Argand

Expected Grade: _____

Oisín Argand